

Ian Cowpar

Delivery & transformation leader — structure from ambiguity | change adoption without authority | outcomes over timelines | zero-translation building

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SUMMARY

Delivery leader who steps into evolving, ambiguous initiatives and brings structure, alignment, and forward momentum — then owns the outcome, not just the timeline. Two years at UKG bringing order to undefined, high-stakes work inside a \$250M ARR enterprise program: built functions from zero with no top-down mandate, drove cross-functional delivery and adoption across product, engineering, and services, and influenced senior stakeholders without direct authority in a highly matrixed organization. A decade prior at Broadridge Financial Solutions leading 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade, regulated environment. Local to the Commonwealth — Methuen, MA.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

UKG | Lowell, MA | \$250M ARR enterprise program | Structure, delivery, and change adoption across product, engineering, and services

- **Stepped into an undefined 0→1 initiative and brought structure end-to-end.** Took an ambiguous concept through governance and decomposition (UI, rules, deployment epics), built the working prototype myself, ran the stakeholder feedback loop, and handed a complete delivery package — plans, epics, work breakdown, Gantt, roadmap — engineering-ready in one week. In production with the first cohort: 6 enterprise accounts in flight, business users running it without an engineering ticket. Owned the outcome, not just execution.
- **Led an organization-wide adoption effort with no mandate behind it.** Built shared infrastructure 20 colleagues could pull from, ran the first enablement group, and coached individuals through their own use cases. Designed to spread and sustain without a directive — because the only adoption that holds is the kind nobody had to order. Direct change-management proof: people, process, and tooling.
- **Brought clarity to a chaotic, underdefined problem space.** Designed a five-panel operational system classifying open issues across escalations, defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise across four products; cut a ~200-item working list to a real five so leadership acted on signal, not noise. Opinionated routing, not a dashboard.
- **Built executive-grade governance and reporting cadence.** Created a composite risk model scoring the top accounts on exposure, case volume, true-defect signal, and sentiment — not raw counts — with automated weekly status that surfaced aging risks and routed every blocker to the program lead before escalation.
- **Designed delivery-health instrumentation** refreshing every 15 minutes across two teams, with documented criteria for burndown, velocity, and delivery anti-patterns — process governance built for signal, not ceremony.
- **Operated in the executive escalation room** — synthesizing what 300 enterprise customers (\$250M ARR) needed versus what was committed, building alignment across groups with competing priorities, and stabilizing at-risk delivery.

Business Analyst Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

- Led 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade, regulated financial services environment — scope definition through delivery, with stakeholder alignment, governance, and technical-and-business alignment owned throughout.

- Influenced cross-functional teams and senior client stakeholders without direct authority; translated loosely defined business needs into structured plans and actionable deliverables.
- Internal SME for an omni-channel product adopted across the full client base; drove process redesign and adoption, turning complex regulated capabilities into workflows non-technical users could operate without support.

Sr. Document Development Analyst Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

- Built and maintained complex client-facing systems in a regulated financial services environment — the governance and requirements-rigor foundation the later deployment-leadership work was built on.

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

Delivery & Program Leadership: Enterprise-scale initiative delivery, structure from ambiguity, scope/governance definition where process doesn't yet exist, owning outcomes not just execution, at-risk stabilization, multi-initiative portfolio operation

Change Management & Adoption: Organizational change across people/process/technology, stakeholder engagement and communication strategy, adoption design that sustains without mandate, resistance identification and mitigation

Stakeholder & Executive Engagement: Influence without authority in highly matrixed orgs, executive-level presentations and concise written reporting, alignment across executives, technical teams, vendors, and business partners

Governance & Methodology: Agile/Scrum, Waterfall, and hybrid delivery; enterprise governance frameworks; project artifacts (plans, timelines, budgets, executive comms); risk and dependency management; post-implementation review and PMO-process improvement

Technical & AI Fluency: Enterprise systems and integration tradeoffs, business process mapping and workflow optimization, AI-fluent prototyping (Claude Code), data and analytics, requirements engineering

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, Microsoft Project—class planning, SQL, GitHub

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell | 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) | theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on change adoption, unofficial leadership, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework.